

ADVANCED WATER SAFETY

Parent & Carer Information Sheet | Year 9-10 | Victorian Curriculum F-10 Version 2.0

What your child is learning in the Advanced Water Safety unit.
How they will be assessed and how you can support them at home.
VCHPEP143 | VCHPEP144 | VCHPEP147 | VCHPEP148 | VCHPEM162

SCHOOL	TEACHER	TERM / YEAR
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What Is Your Child Learning?

The Advanced Water Safety unit builds on the Year 7-8 program.

At this level students move beyond learning the rules to analysing why water safety problems exist and what can be done about them. This develops critical thinking, research skills, and health literacy.

Topic	What students learn
Victorian & global drowning data	Students calculate and interpret real drowning rate statistics from the LSV Victorian Drowning Report.
Physiology of drowning	How drowning affects the body, why CPR within 4 minutes is critical, cold water shock, and secondary drowning.
Social determinants of drowning risk	Why males and CALD communities face higher risk — and how structural factors drive this inequity.
Prevention strategy evaluation	Assessing what actually works to prevent drowning, with reference to evidence.
International comparison	Comparing Australian water safety approaches to those used in the UK and USA.

How Will My Child Be Assessed?

Students choose ONE of three summative assessment task options:

Option A — Policy Brief (600-800 words)

Addressed to the Victorian Minister for Sport. Two evidence-based recommendations, evidence base, and measurable success metrics.

Option B — Awareness Campaign

A campaign targeting one high-risk group, with a 100-word justification of design choices and evidence base.

Option C — School Audit (advanced) ★

An audit of the school's water safety provision benchmarked against Victorian Curriculum requirements, with recommendations.

A rubric is provided to students at the start of the unit so they know exactly what is expected. It assesses six criteria: data analysis, physiological knowledge, social determinants, prevention evaluation, international comparison, and communication product quality.

How Can I Support My Child at Home?

Try asking your child:

- "What did you find most surprising about the Victorian drowning data?"
- "Why do you think young men are more likely to drown than young women?"
- "What would you do if you saw someone drowning at the beach?"
- "If you had \$5 million to reduce drowning in Victoria, what would you do?"
- "What is the difference between how Australia and the UK teach water safety?"

Useful websites for their assessment research:

- Life Saving Victoria: lsv.com.au/research/victorian-drowning-reports/
- Royal Life Saving Society Australia: royallifesaving.com.au
- World Health Organization: who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/drowning
- RLSS UK: rlss.org.uk/education

✂ Please return this section to your child's teacher by: _____

Student name	Parent / Carer name	Signature & date

☐ I have read this information sheet and discussed it with my child.

☐ I have questions — please contact me. My contact: _____